Alvaro Mercado

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER · ARCHITECTURE · CLOUD & INFRASTRUCTURE

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with **14 years** designing, building and optimizing production systems — much of it as an **independent contractor for international clients via Upwork** (**5.0★** rating, 10,000+ billed hours across 10 projects), and currently at **ITTI**, one of Paraguay's leading fintech companies. Specialized in **system design** and **resource optimization**, with a growing focus on Cloud/DevOps across GCP, AWS and Kubernetes. Experienced with electronic invoicing (SIFEN) and payment gateways, and with workflow automation and **AI agent orchestration** (MCP). Native Spanish, advanced English.

EXPERIENCE

ITTI — Fintech/Regtech · e-invoicing, payments & core banking

2024 — Present · 2 yrs

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Development and maintenance of **BIMS**, a system serving **1,000+ clients nationwide**, including integration with **SIFEN** (Paraguay's national e-invoicing system), within one of the country's leading fintech/regtech companies (ISO 27001/9001 certified). Working on legacy systems: bugfixing and code/infrastructure optimization (Redis caching, SQS queues), deployments on **AWS and GCP**, and redesign of delivery processes to speed up client delivery. **Automation of management workflows and orchestration of AI agents with MCP integrations.** Security hardening and performance monitoring, in cross-functional teams of 20+ engineers.

`CakePHP` `PHP` `SIFEN` `Legacy systems` `Redis` `SQS` `AWS` `GCP` `Kubernetes` `Docker` `PostgreSQL` `AI Agents` `Agent orchestration` `MCP`

eLeap LMS

2020 — 2024 · 4 yrs

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

Design and implementation of features for a large-scale LMS, working on legacy systems. Code improvements, REST API endpoints and database optimization with Percona DB.

`Laravel` `JavaScript` `PerconaDB` `Legacy systems` `Bootstrap CSS` `Core PHP` `Amplitude`

TowerHouseStudio

2020 — 2021 · 1 yr

BACK-END DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

Web features with Laravel 8 and AWS (SQS queues). CronJob implementation, Scrum methodology and Docker-based infrastructure.

`Laravel` `AWS` `SQS` `Docker` `CronJobs` `Scrum`

ChatterSourse

2020 · 6 mos

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

CMS with full API and UI, JWT authentication and role-based access control with Laravel, Vue.js and Tailwind CSS.

`Laravel` `Vue.js` `MySQL` `Docker` `Tailwind CSS` `Git`

Petcheck Technology

2017 — 2020 · 3 yrs

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER & TESTER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

API implementation and documentation with Laravel. Legacy platform maintenance with CodeIgniter and React.js. Built a full automated test suite with Selenium in JavaScript.

`Laravel` `Node.js` `React.js` `Selenium` `MySQL` `CodeIgniter` `Legacy systems` `Bootstrap CSS`

Borealis Consulting

2015 — 2016 · 1 yr

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · CONTRACTOR

Full-stack development with CodeIgniter, Laravel and Ruby on Rails. UI design and database management with MySQL and PostgreSQL.

`Laravel` `CodeIgniter` `Ruby on Rails` `MySQL` `PostgreSQL`

Amedia Creative Inc

2012 — 2014 · 2 yrs

JR. DEVELOPER · CONTRACTOR

Backend and frontend development with the Zend PHP framework, HTML, CSS, JavaScript and MySQL, on a management system for a textile company.

`PHP` `Zend` `JavaScript` `MySQL` `HTML/CSS`

SKILLS

ARCHITECTURE & CLOUD/DEVOPS

System design · Resource optimization · GCP · AWS · Kubernetes · Docker · Linux · Bash · CI/CD · SQS · Hardening & Monitoring

BACKEND

PHP · Laravel · CakePHP · CodeIgniter · Zend · Node.js · TypeScript · REST API

FRONTEND

React.js · Vue.js · Nuxt.js · JavaScript · Tailwind CSS · Bootstrap

DATABASES

PostgreSQL · MySQL · PerconaDB · MongoDB · Redis

DOMAIN & PRODUCTIVITY

SIFEN / E-invoicing · Payment gateways · AI-assisted development · AI agent orchestration (MCP) · Legacy systems

TESTING & TOOLS

Selenium · Unit testing · Load testing · Git · Scrum

EDUCATION

Software Engineering — 2010 — 2021
Universidad Nacional de Itapúa

Linux Systems Administration — 2012
Universidad Nacional de Itapúa

Associate Cloud Engineer (GCP) — In progress
Google Cloud

LANGUAGES

Spanish — Native

English — Advanced